Pico Mini CMU Africa
Hidden in Plainsight

Hidden in plainsight

Easy | Forensics | picoMini by CMU-Africa | browser_webshell_solvable

In this challenge, we're asked to take a look at a JPG image. We need to find the hidden info, the flag, in the file

Pico - Hidden in Plainsight
EXIF Metadata

Comment

c3RlZ2hpZGU6Y0VGNmVuZHZjbVE9

We can look at the metadata of this file using the `Exiftool` command, and we see an interesting string in the `Comment` field of the metadata

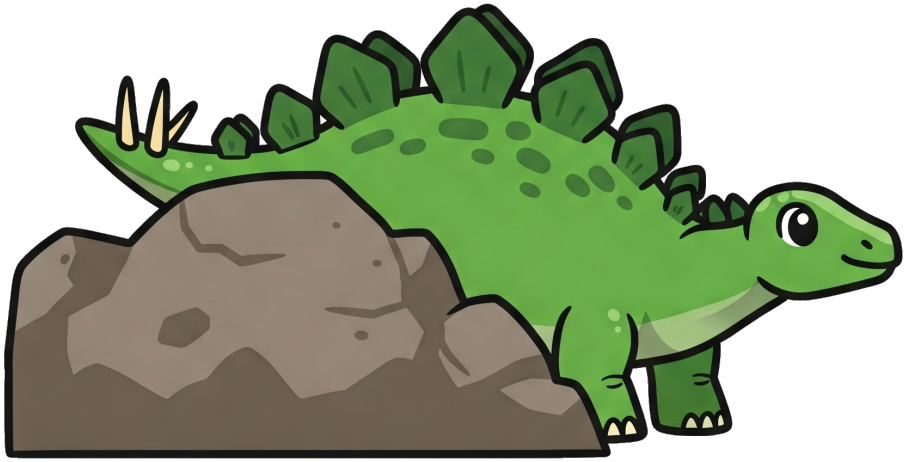
Pico - Hidden in Plainsight Base64-Encoded String

```
└─$ echo 'c3RlZ2hpZGU6Y0VGNmVuZHZjbVE9' | base64 -d
steghide:cEF6endvcmQ=
```

This comment is a string encoded with the Base64 encoding method. If we decode the string, we see a mention to something called `steghide`, and another Base64-encoded string

Pico - Hidden in Plainsight Steganography

Steghide is a program used for steganography, which is a method for hiding secret information inside files, usually media files such as pictures, audio files or video files



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```
└─$ echo 'cEF6endvcmQ=' | base64 -d
pAzzword
```

But we also saw another base64-encoded string when we base64 decoded, didn't we? When we decode that string as well, we discover what might be a password

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```
└─$ echo 'cEF6endvcmQ=' | base64 -d
pAzzword
```

The steghide program is used to hide files inside other files, and we usually need a password to retrieve the hidden files

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```
└─$ steghide extract -sf img.jpg -p pAzzword
wrote extracted data to "flag.txt".
```

So we can use the steghide program with the password we found to extract a hidden file from the picture